SSC GD Constable 2022 question paper with answers

8 February 2023 · Shift 3

73 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 7 of the paper's 80 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20230219070003/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Write_up_Constable_GD_2022_18022023.pdf

Part-A-General Intelligence and Reasoning 16 questions

Q.1

Which of the mathematical signs should be interchanged in the below equation to make it mathematically correct? 360 × 9 - 320 + 72 ÷ 5 = 80

(A) + and ÷
(B) - and ÷
(C) × and ÷
(D) + and ×

Q.2

In this question, three statements are given, followed by two conclusions numbered I and II. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusion(s) logically follows/follow from the statements. Statements: All fields are gardens. All gardens are parks. Some gardens are apartments. Conclusions: I. Some apartments are parks. II. All fields are parks.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(C) Only conclusion I follow.
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.

Q.3

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must not be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word.) Mare : Stallion :: Cow : ?

(A) Herd
(B) Milk
(C) Calf
(D) Bull

Q.4

In a certain code language, ‘fever origin’ is coded as ‘tree cloud’, ‘apple origin’ is coded as ‘brown cloud’, and ‘sandwich fever’ is coded as ‘shoe tree’. What is the code word for ‘apple’?

(A) fever
(B) cloud
(C) sandwich
(D) brown

Q.5

Which option represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in the English dictionary? 1 Magical 2 Magnificent 3 Marble 4 Marvellous 5 Marigold

(A) 1,2,3,4,5
(B) 1,4,3,2,5
(C) 1,3,2,4,5
(D) 1,2,3,5,4

Q.6

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and fourth term is related to the third term. ENGLISH : HSILGNE :: BIOLOGY : YGOLOIB :: PHYSICS : ?

(A) SPSICSY
(B) SYPHSIC
(C) SCISYHP
(D) PYHISCS

Q.7

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? JSCM, ?, NYKW, PBOB, RESG

(A) LVGR
(B) NXIS
(C) MUHQ
(D) MWHS

Q.10

'A + B' means 'B is the father of A'; 'A @ B' means 'B is the brother of A'; 'A $ B' means 'B is the husband of A'; 'A & B' means 'B is the wife of A'; If A @ B + C & D @ E, then how is E related to A?

(A) Mother's brother
(B) Son
(C) Husband
(D) Brother

Q.11

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 20 : 2 :: 42 : 4 :: 72 : ?

(A) 14
(B) 10
(C) 6
(D) 8

Q.13

Seven people, A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting in a straight row, facing north. Only two people sit between D and G. Only four people sit between G and A. B sits fourth to the right of A. G is sitting immediately between B and F. F is sitting fifth to the right of C. Who is sitting at the third position from the left end of the row?

(A) E
(B) B
(C) A
(D) D

Q.14

Four friends Ram, Shyam, Sunil and Anil are sitting around a circular table facing the centre. If Ram is sitting to the immediate left of Sunil and Shyam is not sitting next to Ram, then who is sitting to the immediate left of Shyam?

(A) Ram
(B) Either Ram or Sunil
(C) Sunil
(D) Anil

Q.15

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 59, 72, 87, 104, ?, 144

(A) 123
(B) 127
(C) 121
(D) 125

Q.16

If '+' means '×', '÷' means '+', '-' means '÷', and '×' means '-'. Which of the following will be the value of the expression 48 ÷ 72 – 6 × 18 + 3

(A) 6
(B) 12
(C) 16
(D) 18

Q.17

Which number will replace the question mark (?) in the following series? 125, 120, 130, ?, 135, 110

(A) 140
(B) 115
(C) 150
(D) 110

Q.19

Which of the following letters will replace the question mark (?) and complete the following letter series? K, N, R, W, C, ?

(A) J
(B) K
(C) L
(D) I

Q.20

In a code language, ‘he came forward' is coded as 'ar ka mu', 'move forward' is coded as ‘ba mu', and 'he must move' is coded as ‘ar du ba’. What is the code for the word 'must'?

(A) mu
(B) ar
(C) du
(D) ba

Part-B-General Knowledge and General awareness 20 questions

Q.1

In a food chain, _____ can be taken as the average value for the amount of organic matter that is present at each step and reaches the next level of consumers.

(A) 1%
(B) 0.01%
(C) 0.1%
(D) 10%

Q.2

Who has been appointed as the second Chief of Defence Staff of India?

(A) General Manoj Mukund Naravane
(B) Lieutenant General Anil Chauhan
(C) General Manoj Pande
(D) Lieutenant General Baggavalli Somashekar Raju

Q.3

Electric current in a circuit is measured by _____.

(A) voltmeter
(B) odometer
(C) potential meter
(D) ammeter

Q.4

In 1986, an operation had to be conducted against terrorists in the Golden Temple. What was the name of this operation?

(A) Operation Lightning Thunder
(B) Operation Thunder
(C) Operation Black Thunder
(D) Operation Rain and Thunder

Q.5

In which year was the Rural Employment Generation Program launched in India?

(A) 1995
(B) 2000
(C) 2004
(D) 1997

Q.6

Natya Visharadha presented by His Excellency Shankar Dayal Sharma, in 1994 was given to _____.

(A) Sunanda Nair
(B) G. Padmaja Reddy
(C) Shovana Narayan
(D) Anuradha Pandey

Q.7
When a national GST subsumed central taxes on July 1, 2017, how many petroleum goods were kept out of its purview for the time being?

(A) Five
(B) Four
(C) Six
(D) Three

Q.8
Fa Xian began his journey back from _____.

(A) Tibet
(B) Madurai
(C) Bengal
(D) Patliputra

Q.9
Vishu is a _____ festival, celebrated primarily in the southern part of India.

(A) Buddhist
(B) Parsi
(C) Hindu
(D) Jain

Q.10
As of November 2022, who among the following is the Chief Minister of Jharkhand, India?

(A) Raghubar Das
(B) Pankaj Mishra
(C) Hemant Soren
(D) Amit Shah

Q.11
There were two Annual Programs implemented in India in 1990-91 and 1991-92 (between_____ five year plans).

(A) first and second
(B) third and fourth
(C) fifth and sixth
(D) seventh and eighth

Q.12
In India, the ‘Green Revolution’ mainly started in the _____.

(A) 1950's
(B) 1980's
(C) 1970's
(D) 1960's

Q.13
Which of the following is caused by Loo?

(A) Hypothermia
(B) Frost Bite
(C) Heat Stroke
(D) Chilblains

Q.14
Parliament consists of _____. (i) President (ii) The Council of States (iii) The House of the People

(A) (i), (ii) and (iii)
(B) Both (i) and (iii)
(C) Both (ii) and (iii)
(D) Only (i)

Q.15
Which schedule of Indian constitution contains languages of Republic of India?

(A) 8
(B) 7
(C) 9
(D) 6

Q.16
What happens in plantation farming?

(A) single crop is grown
(B) multiple crops are grown
(C) only two crops are grown
(D) crop is rotated

Q.17

There are _____ hand gestures in Mohiniyattam which are mainly adopted from Hastalakshana Deepika text.

(A) 18
(B) 20
(C) 24
(D) 28

Q.18

Milkha Singh, the Flying Sikh, was the first Indian to win a gold medal in which of the following games?

(A) Championship Series
(B) Asian Games
(C) Winter Olympics
(D) Commonwealth Games

Q.19

The Logo of 36th National Games of India contains a Picture of_____.

(A) Zebra
(B) Tiger
(C) Horse
(D) Lion

Q.20

Constitutional requirement to present the Annual Financial Statement before parliament is given in article_____ of the Constitution of India.

(A) 12
(B) 123
(C) 121
(D) 112

Part-C-Elementary Mathematics 17 questions

Q.1

In a 100-metre race, A can beat B by 20 m and B can beat by C 10 m. In the same race, A can beat C by:

(A) 28 m
(B) 30 m
(C) 26 m
(D) 20 m

Q.2

A batsman scores 50, 56, 42, 38 and 78 in his 5 innings. How much does he need to score in his 6th inning to get his average to 60 in 6 innings?

(A) 90
(B) 96
(C) 100
(D) 106

Q.3

Find the discount, if the marked price of book is Rs.500 and sold it for Rs. 400.

(A) Rs. 60
(B) Rs. 100
(C) Rs. 50
(D) Rs. 200

Q.4

Potato's per-kilogram price has risen from Rs.18 to Rs.25. What should be the percentage reduction in potato use so that expenditure does NOT increase?

(A) 28%
(B) 31%
(C) 22%
(D) 34%

Q.6

The difference between the value of a number increased by 5 percent and the value of a number decreased by 15 percent is 9. What is the original number?

(A) 30
(B) 60
(C) 55
(D) 45

Q.8

The sides of a triangle are 5 cm, 12 cm and 13 cm. The area (in cm^2) of the triangle formed by joining the mid-points of the sides of the triangle is:

(A) 7.5 cm^2 **(B)** 21.5 cm^2

(C) 15 cm^2 **(D)** 30 cm^2

Q.9

When 20% of first number is added to second number, the second number increases by 50%. What is the ratio of the first number to the second number?

(A) 5 : 3 **(B)** 2 : 5

(C) 3 : 5 **(D)** 5 : 2

Q.10

What will be the amount due on Rs.25,000 in 2 years when the rate of interest in successive years is 12% and 10% per annum respectively (interest is compounding annually)?

(A) Rs.30,800 **(B)** Rs.33,800

(C) Rs.28,000 **(D)** Rs.27,800

Q.11

Prem can do a piece of work in 112 days. Ben can do this work in 90 days. Prem started the work alone. After how many days should Ben join him, so that the total work is finished in 56 days?

(A) 10 days **(B)** 8 days

(C) 11 days **(D)** 7 days

Q.12

What is the fourth proportional to the numbers 10,16 and 20?

(A) 28 **(B)** 24

(C) 32 **(D)** 30

Q.13

The difference between the selling prices of an article available in two schemes of successive discounts 25% followed by 30%, and 25% followed by 20% is ₹75. Find the marked price of the article (in ₹).

(A) 900 **(B)** 1500

(C) 1200 **(D)** 1000

Q.14

A watch is sold for Rs.15,000 at a loss of 25%. What is the cost price of the watch?

(A) Rs.18,500 **(B)** Rs.20,000

(C) Rs.16,000 **(D)** Rs.18,000

Q.15

Ajay can do a piece of work in 20 days and Vijay can do the same work in 22 days. In how many days they will complete the work together if they work on alternate days and the work is started by Vijay?

(A) 20 **(B)** 21

(C) 22 **(D)** 24

Q.17

A faulty machine weighs 900 g as 1000 g. A shopkeeper uses this weighing machine to sell 45 kg of rice at Rs.65 per kg which he bought at Rs.58 per kg. His overall profit percentage is approximately equal to:

(A) 23.8% **(B)** 18.9%

(C) 22.6% **(D)** 24.5%

Q.18

The value of a machine in a company depreciates by 10% every year. Determine the value (in Rs.) of the machine after 2 years if the current value is Rs.2 lakh.

(A) 1,64,000
(B) 1,80,000
(C) 1,60,000
(D) 1,62,000

Q.19

There are four sections: A, B, C and D of class X in a school. In every section, there are 30 students. The average score in maths of the four sections is 89.8, 92.6, 99.1 and 94.5, respectively. What is the average score in maths of the whole class X in that school?

(A) 96.8
(B) 95.0
(C) 92.5
(D) 94.0

Q.20

R runs for 10 hours at speeds of 10 km/h, 9 km/h, …,1 km/h, respectively, in the first hour, second hour, and so on. His average speed is _____ km/h.

(A) 4.5
(B) 5
(C) 6
(D) 5.5

Part-D-English 20 questions

Q.1

Select the word similar in meaning to the given word. Skip

(A) Overlook
(B) Insert
(C) Notice
(D) Introduce

Q.2

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. After studying the evidence thoroughly, the detective “inferred” the motive.

(A) unusually concealed
(B) logically concluded
(C) intensely disliked
(D) violently criticised

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word to fill in the blank. The “servile” nature of the employees was contrary to the employer’s _____ nature.

(A) dishonest
(B) dominant
(C) curious
(D) furious

Q.4

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Influence

(A) Impact
(B) Stir
(C) Effect
(D) Deter

Q.5

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them contains a spelling error. Select the option that rectifies the error. Superbugs are the bacteria that have accquired resistance to several types of antibiotics either through genetic mutation or through buildup resistance over time.

(A) resistence
(B) bactaria
(C) mutattion
(D) acquired

Q.6

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. If the linguistic minority refuses to vote, it may “rock the boat”.

(A) Lead to protests
(B) Topple the government
(C) Upset the balance
(D) Restore the equilibrium

Q.7

Select the option in which all the words are spelt correctly.

(A) Our school principal declared that the new rule was applicable to everyone.
(B) Our school principal declared that the new rule was aplicable to everyone.
(C) Our school principal declared that the new rule was appleecable to everyone.
(D) Our school principal declared that the new rule was applikable to everyone.

Q.8

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. My dad asked my mom to prepare lunch early as he was “feeling very hungry.”

(A) terrible
(B) exhausted
(C) starved
(D) tired

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Due to some technical emergency, the helicopter was supposed to land on a _____ (occupied) piece of land.

(A) jammed
(B) active
(C) vacant
(D) teeming

Q.10

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Amputate

(A) Brighten
(B) Energise
(C) Sever
(D) Argue

Q.11

Select the most appropriate synonym of the word given in brackets to fill in the blank. His best friend _____ (disclose) his business secrets in the press conference.

(A) revealed
(B) deceived
(C) concealed
(D) superseded

Q.12

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The policeman / walk along the / road when I saw / a body in the gutter.

(A) walk along the
(B) a body in the gutter
(C) The policeman
(D) road when I saw

Q.13

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Once in a blue moon

(A) Very rarely
(B) To agree reluctantly
(C) A quick response
(D) Moon in the night

Q.14

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Rival

(A) Employer
(B) Comrade
(C) Opponent
(D) Antagonist

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. One should never _____ from pals or activities that formerly provided solace.

(A) remove
(B) withdraw
(C) suspend
(D) deduct

Q.16

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One of the (1) _____ that Elizabeth had to attend was ballet, and she loathed it. She would stuff (2) _____ into her pink tut, and stare at her (3) _____ in the mirror and try to tell herself that she was not made for dance. But the truth was (4) _____ for her to see. She was having two left feet. She (5) _____ never be a ballet dancer.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) Seminars
(B) lectures
(C) classes
(D) Meetings

Q.17

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One of the (1) _____ that Elizabeth had to attend was ballet, and she loathed it. She would stuff (2) _____ into her pink tut, and stare at her (3) _____ in the mirror and try to tell herself that she was not made for dance. But the truth was (4) _____ for her to see. She was having two left feet. She (5) _____ never be a ballet dancer.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) oneself
(B) himself
(C) herself
(D) Ourselves

Q.18

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One of the (1) _____ that Elizabeth had to attend was ballet, and she loathed it. She would stuff (2) _____ into her pink tut, and stare at her (3) _____ in the mirror and try to tell herself that she was not made for dance. But the truth was (4) _____ for her to see. She was having two left feet. She (5) _____ never be a ballet dancer.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) photograph
(B) Sketch
(C) Painting
(D) image

Q.19

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One of the (1) _____ that Elizabeth had to attend was ballet, and she loathed it. She would stuff (2) _____ into her pink tut, and stare at her (3) _____ in the mirror and try to tell herself that she was not made for dance. But the truth was (4) _____ for her to see. She was having two left feet. She (5) _____ never be a ballet dancer.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) their
(B) there
(C) Therein
(D) Here

Q.20

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One of the (1) _____ that Elizabeth had to attend was ballet, and she loathed it. She would stuff (2) _____ into her pink tut, and stare at her (3) _____ in the mirror and try to tell herself that she was not made for dance. But the truth was (4) _____ for her to see. She was having two left feet. She (5) _____ never be a ballet dancer.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) Ever
(B) would
(C) can't
(D) won't

Answer key

Part-A-General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**
Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**		

Part-B-General Knowledge and General awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**				

Part-C-Elementary Mathematics

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**
Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**
Q.15 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**	

Part-D-English

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**				

Explanations

Part-A-General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (C) × and ÷

After interchanging × and ÷: 360 ÷ 9 – 320 + 72 × 5 = 40 – 320 + 360 = 80.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Both conclusions I and II follow.

All fields are gardens and all gardens are parks, so all fields are parks (II). The gardens that are apartments are parks too, so some apartments are parks (I). Both follow.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Bull

A mare is a female horse and a stallion a male one; the male of the cow is the bull.

Q.4 · Answer (D) brown

'Origin' is 'cloud' (in the first two codes) and 'fever' is 'tree' (the first and third). So 'apple', the other word of 'apple origin', is 'brown'.

Q.5 · Answer (D) 1,2,3,5,4

In dictionary order: Magical (1), Magnificent (2), Marble (3), Marigold (5), Marvellous (4). 'Magi' comes before 'Magn', 'Mag' before 'Mar', and 'Marb', 'Mari' and 'Marv' follow the alphabet.

Q.6 · Answer (C) SCISYHP

Each second term is the first written backwards: ENGLISH → HSILGNE and BIOLOGY → YGOLOIB. So PHYSICS → SCISYHP.

Q.7 · Answer (A) LVGR

The first letters move +2 (J, L, N, P, R), the second +3 (S, V, Y, B, E, wrapping round after Z), the third +4 (C, G, K, O, S) and the fourth +5 (M, R, W, B, G): LVGR.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Mother's brother

A @ B: B is A's brother. B + C: C is B's father, so also A's father. C & D: D is C's wife, A's mother. D @ E: E is D's brother, so E is A's mother's brother.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 6

20 = 4 × 5, 42 = 6 × 7 and 72 = 8 × 9, and each second number is the smaller factor less 2: 4 – 2 = 2 and 6 – 2 = 4, so 8 – 2 = 6. (Taking the first digit would give 7, which is not an option.)

Q.13 · Answer (D) D

Four people sit between G and A and B is fourth to the right of A, so counting from the left A is 1st, B 5th and G 6th. F, beside G, is 7th, C (five places to F's left) 2nd, D (with two people between D and G) 3rd and E 4th: A, C, D, E, B, G, F. The third from the left is D.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Sunil

Shyam, not next to Ram, sits opposite him. Facing the centre, each person's immediate left is the next seat clockwise, so clockwise the order is Sunil, Ram, Anil, Shyam and back to Sunil: Sunil is on Shyam's immediate left.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 123

The differences are 13, 15, 17, 19 and 21: 104 + 19 = 123, and 123 + 21 = 144.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 6

After replacing the signs: 48 + 72 ÷ 6 – 18 × 3 = 48 + 12 – 54 = 6.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 115

Two series alternate: 125, 130, 135 rise by 5 and 120, ?, 110 fall by 5, so the missing term is 115.

Q.19 · Answer (A) J

The letters move +3, +4, +5 and +6 (W → C, wrapping round after Z), so the next move is +7: C → J.

Q.20 · Answer (C) du

'Forward' is 'mu' (in the first two codes), 'he' is 'ar' (the first and third) and 'move' is 'ba' (the second and third). So 'must', the remaining word of 'he must move', is 'du'.

Part-B-General Knowledge and General awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) 10%

On average only about 10% of the organic matter at each step of a food chain reaches the next level of consumers; the rest is used in the organisms' own life processes or lost as heat.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Lieutenant General Anil Chauhan

Lieutenant General Anil Chauhan (retired) was appointed India's second Chief of Defence Staff in September 2022, with the rank of General, after the first, General Bipin Rawat, died in December 2021. He held the post when the exam was held (February 2023).

Q.3 · Answer (D) ammeter

An ammeter, connected in series, measures electric current; a voltmeter, connected in parallel, measures potential difference, and an odometer measures distance travelled.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Operation Black Thunder

Operation Black Thunder, on the night of 30 April 1986, sent National Security Guard commandos and Border Security Force troops into the Golden Temple in Amritsar to flush out militants; a second Operation Black Thunder followed in May 1988.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 1995

The Rural Employment Generation Programme, a Khadi and Village Industries Commission scheme to help set up village industries, ran from 1 April 1995; in 2008 it was merged with the Prime Minister's Rozgar Yojana into the PMEGP.

Q.6 · Answer (B) G. Padmaja Reddy

The Kuchipudi dancer G. Padmaja Reddy received the title 'Natya Visharadha' from President Shankar Dayal Sharma in 1994; she received the Padma Shri in 2022.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Five

When GST came in on 1 July 2017, five petroleum products were kept out of it for the time being: crude oil, petrol (motor spirit), high-speed diesel, natural gas and aviation turbine fuel.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Bengal

The Chinese pilgrim Fa Xian set out for home from Bengal: he sailed on a merchant ship from Tamralipti, a port in Bengal, to Sri Lanka, and went on to China by sea.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Hindu

Vishu, the new year festival on the first day of the Malayalam month of Medam (mid-April), is a Hindu festival celebrated mainly in Kerala; the day begins with the 'Vishukkani', an arrangement of auspicious things seen first thing in the morning.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Hemant Soren

Hemant Soren of the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha was Chief Minister of Jharkhand in November 2022, and still when the exam was held (February 2023); he had taken office for the second time on 29 December 2019, succeeding Raghubar Das.

Q.11 · Answer (D) seventh and eighth

The Seventh Five Year Plan ran from 1985 to 1990 and the Eighth began in 1992, so the Annual Plans of 1990-91 and 1991-92 came between them.

Q.12 · Answer (D) 1960's

The Green Revolution began in India in the mid-1960s, with high-yielding varieties of wheat and rice, chiefly in Punjab, Haryana and western Uttar Pradesh.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Heat Stroke
The loo is the hot, dry wind that blows over north and north-western India on summer afternoons in May and June, and exposure to it can cause heat stroke. Hypothermia, frostbite and chilblains come from cold.

Q.14 · Answer (A) (i), (ii) and (iii)
Under Article 79, Parliament consists of the President and two Houses, the Council of States (Rajya Sabha) and the House of the People (Lok Sabha).

Q.15 · Answer (A) 8
The Eighth Schedule lists the languages recognised by the Constitution: 22 when the exam was held (February 2023), the last four (Bodo, Dogri, Maithili and Santali) added by the Ninety-second Amendment Act, 2003.

Q.16 · Answer (A) single crop is grown
Plantation farming is a type of commercial farming in which a single crop, such as tea, coffee, rubber or sugarcane, is grown on a large estate.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 24
Mohiniyattam's hand gestures come mainly from the Hastalakshana Deepika, a Kerala text on hand gestures that describes 24 basic mudras.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Commonwealth Games
Milkha Singh won the 440 yards at the 1958 British Empire and Commonwealth Games in Cardiff, India's first gold medal at those Games. He also won Asian Games gold in 1958, but India had won Asian Games golds before, at the first Games in 1951.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Lion
The logo of the 36th National Games, held in Gujarat in 2022, shows the head of an Asiatic lion, made up of sports pictograms, with the Statue of Unity: two symbols of Gujarat.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 112
Article 112 requires the President to have the Annual Financial Statement, the budget, laid before both Houses of Parliament for every financial year.

Part-C-Elementary Mathematics

Q.1 · Answer (A) 28 m
When A runs 100 m, B runs 80 m; when B runs 100 m, C runs 90 m, so when B runs 80 m, C runs 72 m. A beats C by 100 – 72 = 28 m.

Q.2 · Answer (B) 96
He needs 6 × 60 = 360 runs in all; the five innings give 50 + 56 + 42 + 38 + 78 = 264, so he needs 360 – 264 = 96.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Rs. 100
Discount = marked price – selling price = ₹500 – ₹400 = ₹100.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 28%
To keep the spending the same, use must fall by the rise as a share of the new price: (25 – 18)/25 × 100 = 28%.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 45
1.05x – 0.85x = 0.2x = 9, so x = 45.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 7.5 cm²
$5^2 + 12^2 = 13^2$, so the triangle is right-angled, with area ½ × 5 × 12 = 30 cm². Joining the mid-points gives a triangle with half the sides and a quarter of the area: 30/4 = 7.5 cm².

Q.9 · Answer (D) 5 : 2
20% of the first number equals 50% of the second: 0.2a = 0.5b, so a : b = 0.5 : 0.2 = 5 : 2.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Rs.30,800
25,000 × 1.12 × 1.10 = 28,000 × 1.10 = ₹30,800.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 11 days
Prem works all 56 days and does 56/112 = 1/2 of the work, so Ben must do the other half, which takes him 45 days. He joins after 56 – 45 = 11 days.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 32
The fourth proportional x satisfies 10 : 16 = 20 : x, so x = 16 × 20/10 = 32.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 1000
The selling prices are 0.75 × 0.70 = 0.525 and 0.75 × 0.80 = 0.60 of the marked price. The difference, 0.075 of it, is ₹75, so the marked price is ₹1,000.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Rs.20,000
At a 25% loss the selling price is 75% of the cost price: 15,000 ÷ 0.75 = ₹20,000.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 21
Take the work as 220 units: Ajay does 11 a day and Vijay 10. Each two-day pair does 21 units, so 10 pairs (20 days) do 210, and Vijay finishes the last 10 units on day 21.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 24.5%
For 45 kg billed he hands over only 45 × 0.9 = 40.5 kg, which cost 40.5 × 58 = ₹2,349, and he takes 45 × 65 = ₹2,925. Profit = 576/2,349 × 100 ≈ 24.5%.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 1,62,000
2,00,000 × 0.9 × 0.9 = ₹1,62,000.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 94.0
The sections are the same size, so the class average is the mean of the four: (89.8 + 92.6 + 99.1 + 94.5)/4 = 376/4 = 94.0.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 5.5
He covers 10 + 9 + … + 1 = 55 km in 10 hours: 55/10 = 5.5 km/h.

Part-D-English

Q.1 · Answer (A) Overlook
To 'skip' something is to pass over it or leave it out, close to 'overlook'. 'Notice' is nearly its opposite, and 'insert' and 'introduce' mean putting something in.

Q.2 · Answer (B) logically concluded
To 'infer' is to reach a conclusion by reasoning from the evidence: the detective 'logically concluded' the motive.

Q.3 · Answer (B) dominant
'Servile' means too eager to obey or serve others; its opposite is 'dominant', inclined to control others, which suits the employer set against the servile employees.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Deter
SSC's key gives 'deter', to discourage someone from doing something, as the opposite of 'influence' in its sense of moving someone to act; it is not an exact antonym, but 'impact' and 'effect' mean much the same as 'influence', and to 'stir' is also to move someone.

Q.5 · Answer (D) acquired
'Accquired' is misspelt: 'acquired' has a single 'c' before the 'q'. The other options misspell words that the sentence spells correctly.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Upset the balance
To 'rock the boat' is to disturb a settled situation and cause trouble: to 'upset the balance'.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Our school principal declared that the new rule was applicable to everyone.
The word is spelt 'applicable', with a double 'p' and the ending '-cable'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) starved
'Starved', in its everyday sense, means very hungry: 'as he was starved'. 'Exhausted' and 'tired' mean weary, not hungry, and 'terrible' does not fit.

Q.9 · Answer (C) vacant
The blank needs the opposite of 'occupied': 'vacant', empty, the kind of land a helicopter can make an emergency landing on. 'Jammed', 'active' and 'teeming' all suggest land that is in use or crowded.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Sever
To 'amputate' is to cut off a limb, so the synonym is 'sever', to cut off.

Q.11 · Answer (A) revealed
To 'disclose' is to make known: 'revealed', in the past tense like the rest of the sentence. 'Concealed' is its opposite.

Q.12 · Answer (A) walk along the
An action in progress when another happened takes the past continuous: 'The policeman was walking along the road when I saw a body in the gutter.'

Q.13 · Answer (A) Very rarely
'Once in a blue moon' means very rarely.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Comrade
A 'rival' is a competitor; a 'comrade', a companion or ally, is the opposite. 'Opponent' and 'antagonist' mean much the same as 'rival'.

Q.15 · Answer (B) withdraw
To 'withdraw from' friends or activities is to pull away from them. 'Remove' would need an object ('remove oneself'), and 'suspend' and 'deduct' do not fit the sense.

Q.16 · Answer (C) classes
Ballet was a lesson Elizabeth had to attend, one of her 'classes'. Seminars, lectures and meetings are not where one learns to dance.

Q.17 · Answer (C) herself
Elizabeth stuffs her own body into the tutu, so the reflexive pronoun is 'herself'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) image
What she stares at in the mirror is her reflection: her 'image'.

Q.19 · Answer (B) there
'The truth was there for her to see' means it was plain to see. 'Their' is a possessive, and 'therein' and 'here' do not fit.

Q.20 · Answer (B) would
The passage is in the past, so 'would' gives what was sure to be true of her future: 'She would never be a ballet dancer.' 'Can't' and 'won't' with 'never' make a double negative.

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